CDC FACTS ON DIABETES

What is prediabetes?

With prediabetes, blood sugar levels are higher than normal but not high enough for a type 2 diabetes diagnosis.

Prediabetes is a serious health condition that increases your risk of developing type 2 diabetes, heart disease, and stroke.

The good news? If you have prediabetes, the CDC-led National Diabetes Prevention Program lifestyle change program can help. When you join, you'll learn to make lifestyle changes that lower your risk and improve your health.

Prediabetes Test

Could you have prediabetes?

Take the Risk Test

What causes prediabetes?

Insulin is a hormone that acts like a key to let blood sugar into cells for use as energy. If you have prediabetes, the cells in your body don't respond normally to insulin. Your pancreas makes more insulin to try to get cells to respond. Eventually your pancreas can't keep up, and your blood sugar rises. This sets the stage for prediabetes—and type 2 diabetes down the road.

Signs and symptoms

You can have prediabetes for years but have no clear symptoms. It often goes undetected until serious health problems such as type 2 diabetes show up. Talk to your doctor about getting your blood sugar tested if you have any risk factors for prediabetes, such as:

- Being overweight
- Being 45 years or older
- Having a parent, brother, or sister with type 2 diabetes
- Being physically active less than 3 times a week
- Ever having gestational diabetes (diabetes during pregnancy)
- Giving birth to a baby who weighed more than 9 pounds
- Having polycystic ovary syndrome

Race and ethnicity are also a factor. African American, Hispanic/Latino American, American Indian, Alaska Native, Pacific Islander, and some Asian American people are at higher risk.

Get tested

You can get a simple blood sugar test to find out if you have prediabetes. Ask your doctor if you should be tested.

Prevent type 2 diabetes

If you have prediabetes, you can lower your risk for developing type 2 diabetes by:

- Losing a small amount of weight if you have overweight.
- Getting regular physical activity.

A small amount of weight loss means around 5% to 7% of your body weight. That's around 10 to 14 pounds for a 200-pound person. Regular physical activity means getting at least 150 minutes a week of brisk walking or a similar activity. That's 30 minutes a day, 5 days a week.

Symptoms of Diabetes

For Everyone
MAY 15, 2024 • ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- Type 1 and type 2 diabetes often develop slowly over time, and both can start with few or no symptoms.
- Gestational diabetes doesn't usually have symptoms. Your doctor should test you for it between 24 and 28 weeks of pregnancy.
- Knowing the symptoms of diabetes can help you to manage your health and prevent complications.

Symptoms

Both type 1 and type 2 diabetes can have similar symptoms, including:

- Frequent urination (peeing).
- Increased thirst and hunger.
- Losing weight without trying.
- Fatigue (tiredness).
- Feeling irritable or moody.
- Blurry vision.
- Frequent urinary tract infections (UTIs) or yeast infections.

KEEP READING
Testing for Diabetes

Symptoms of type 1 diabetes

People with type 1 diabetes in its early stages don't have any symptoms. As type 1 progresses, symptoms can appear suddenly, in just a few weeks or months, and can be severe. People with type 1 diabetes may also have these symptoms:

- Nausea.
- Vomiting.
- Stomach pains.
- Diabetic ketoacidosis (DKA).

Type 1 diabetes is frequently diagnosed in childhood, but it can develop at any age.

Did you know?

In children, unexplained bed-wetting or increased accidents could be a sign of type 1 diabetes. Keep an eye on any changes in bathroom habits if your child is at risk.

Symptoms of type 2 diabetes

Type 2 diabetes symptoms often take several years to develop. Some people don't notice any symptoms at all. Type 2 diabetes usually starts when you're an adult, though more and more children and teens are developing it. Because symptoms are hard to spot, it's important to know the risk factors for type 2 diabetes.

Some additional symptoms more common in type 2 diabetes include:

- Cuts, sores, or wounds that are very slow to heal.
- Dark patches of skin around the neck, armpits, or groin.
- Numbness or tingling in the hands or feet.

KEEP READING
Diabetes Risk Factors

Symptoms of gestational diabetes

Gestational diabetes (diabetes during pregnancy) usually doesn't have any symptoms. If you're pregnant, your doctor should test you for gestational diabetes between 24 and 28 weeks of pregnancy. If needed, you can make changes like healthy eating and being active to protect your health and your baby's health. If those changes aren't enough to manage your blood sugar, your doctor may prescribe medicine to help.

READ NEXT
Just Diagnosed With Type 1 Diabetes

Diabetes Risk Factors

For Everyone
MAY 15, 2024 • ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- Some diabetes risk factors can be managed through behavior change, such as being more physically active.
- Other risk factors can't be changed, such as family history and age.
- Find out your risk for each type of diabetes.

Type 1 diabetes

Type 1 diabetes is thought to be caused by an autoimmune reaction (the body attacks itself by mistake). No one knows how to prevent type 1 diabetes. Known risk factors include:

- Family history: Having a parent, brother, or sister with type 1 diabetes.
- Age: You can get type 1 diabetes at any age, but it usually develops in children, teens, or young adults.

In the United States, White people are more likely to develop type 1 diabetes than African American and Hispanic or Latino people.

Prediabetes and type 2 diabetes

Prediabetes and type 2 diabetes share almost all of the same risk factors. If you already have prediabetes, this is an added risk factor that makes you more likely to develop type 2 diabetes. You're at risk for both prediabetes and type 2 diabetes if you:

- Have overweight or obesity.
- Are age 45 or older.
- Have a parent or sibling with type 2 diabetes.
- Are physically active less than 3 times a week.
- Have non-alcoholic fatty liver disease (NAFLD).
- Have ever had gestational diabetes (diabetes during pregnancy) or given birth to a baby who weighed over 9 pounds.
- Are an African American, Hispanic or Latino, American Indian, or Alaska Native person. Some Pacific Islander people and Asian American people also have a higher risk.

Gestational diabetes

You're at risk for gestational diabetes (diabetes while pregnant) if you:

- Had gestational diabetes during a previous pregnancy.
- Have given birth to a baby who weighed over 9 pounds.
- Have overweight or obesity.
- Are more than 25 years old.
- Have a family history of type 2 diabetes.
- Have a hormone disorder called polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS).
- Are an African American, Hispanic or Latino, American Indian, Alaska Native, Native Hawaiian, or Pacific Islander person.

Gestational diabetes usually goes away after you give birth. But having a history of gestational diabetes increases your risk for type 2 diabetes. The baby is also more likely to have obesity as a child or teen, and to develop type 2 diabetes later in life.

Reduce your risk

Some risk factors like age and family medical history can't be helped. But there are some things you can do to reduce your risk of prediabetes, type 2 diabetes, or gestational diabetes. Some behavior changes to lower your risk include:

- Increasing physical activity.
- Eating a healthy diet.
- Losing weight if you have overweight or obesity.

Small, gradual changes can make a big difference in lowering your risk of prediabetes, type 2 diabetes, or gestational diabetes, and improving your overall health and wellness. It's never too late or too early to get started.

If you have prediabetes and need additional support, help is available through the National Diabetes Prevention Program lifestyle change program. Find out here if you're eligible. You can reverse prediabetes to prevent or delay type 2 diabetes.

Type 2 Diabetes

For Everyone
MAY 15, 2024 • ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- About 1 in 8 Americans has diabetes; most have type 2.
- More children, teens, and young adults are developing type 2 diabetes than in the past.
- Type 2 diabetes can be prevented or delayed with lifestyle changes.

Overview

More than 40 million Americans have diabetes (about 1 in 8), and about 90% to 95% of them have type 2 diabetes. Type 2 diabetes most often develops in people 45 or older, but more and more children, teens, and young adults are also developing it.

Symptoms

Type 2 diabetes symptoms often develop over several years and can go on for a long time without being noticed. Sometimes there aren't any noticeable symptoms at all.

Risk factors

You're at risk for type 2 diabetes if you:

- Have prediabetes.
- Have overweight.
- Are 45 or older.
- Have a parent, brother, or sister with type 2 diabetes.
- Are physically active less than 3 times a week.
- Have ever had gestational diabetes (diabetes during pregnancy) or given birth to a baby who weighed 9 pounds or more.
- Are an African American, Hispanic or Latino, American Indian, or Alaska Native person. Some Pacific Islander people and Asian American people are also at higher risk.

If you have non-alcoholic fatty liver disease you may also be at risk for type 2 diabetes.

You can prevent or delay type 2 diabetes with proven lifestyle changes. These include losing weight if you have overweight, eating a healthy diet, and getting regular physical activity.

Causes

Insulin is a hormone made by your pancreas. It acts like a key to let blood sugar into cells in your body for use as energy. If you have type 2 diabetes, cells don't respond normally to insulin. This is called insulin resistance.

Your pancreas makes more insulin to try to get cells to respond. Over time your pancreas can't keep up, and your blood sugar rises, setting the stage for prediabetes and type 2 diabetes.

High blood sugar is damaging to the body. It can cause other serious health problems, such as heart disease, vision loss, and kidney disease.

KEEP READING
Prediabetes – Your Chance to Prevent Type 2 Diabetes

Testing

A simple blood test will let you know if you have diabetes. If you've gotten your blood sugar tested at a health fair or pharmacy, follow up at a clinic or doctor's office to make sure the results are accurate.

A simple blood test will tell you if you have diabetes. If you've gotten your blood sugar tested at a health fair or pharmacy, follow up at a clinic or doctor's office to make sure the results are accurate.

Managing diabetes

Diabetes is managed mostly by you, with support from your health care team, family, and other important people in your life. Managing diabetes can be challenging, but everything you do to improve your health is worth it!

You may be able to manage your diabetes with healthy eating and being active. Or your doctor may prescribe insulin or other diabetes medicines to help manage your blood sugar and avoid complications. You'll still need to eat healthy and be active if you take insulin or other medicines.

Ask your doctor how often to check your blood sugar and what your target blood sugar levels should be. Keeping your blood sugar levels close to target will help you prevent or delay diabetes complications.

Stress is a part of life, but it can make managing diabetes harder. Regular physical activity, getting enough sleep, and relaxation exercises can help. Talk to your doctor and diabetes educator about these and other ways you can manage stress.

Make regular appointments with your health care team to be sure you're on track with your treatment plan. You can also find out about new ideas and strategies if needed.

Whether you were just diagnosed or have had diabetes for some time, meeting with a diabetes educator for support and guidance is a great idea.

Preventing Type 2 Diabetes in Kids

For Everyone
MAY 15, 2024 • ESPAÑOL

KEY POINTS

- Many people think that only older adults can develop type 2 diabetes, but kids and teens can get it too.
- Type 2 diabetes is increasing in kids and teens in the United States.
- Take action now to help your kids prevent or delay type 2 diabetes.

Risk factors

Weight

About one-third of American youth have overweight. This doesn't automatically mean they're unhealthy, but it does increase risk for some conditions like insulin resistance. Insulin is a key hormone that helps you balance blood sugar levels. Insulin resistance (when you can't use insulin properly) is a major risk factor for type 2 diabetes for kids and adults.

High blood pressure and high cholesterol, conditions that are linked with overweight, can also increase the risk for insulin resistance.

Young kids and teens are still growing. If they have overweight, the goal is to slow down weight gain while still allowing growth and development. Talk to your doctor for dietary advice.

Activity

Being physically inactive increases the risk for type 2 diabetes. Being active helps the body use insulin better and decreases the risk of overweight. Most kids and teens don't get the recommended amount of physical activity per day.

Age

Kids who develop type 2 diabetes are usually diagnosed in their early teens. One reason is that hormones during puberty make it harder for the body to use insulin. This is especially true for girls, who are more likely than boys to develop type 2 diabetes.

More risk factors for type 2 diabetes

- Having a family member with type 2 diabetes.
- Being born to someone with gestational diabetes (diabetes while pregnant).
- Being a Hispanic/Latino, Black Native American/Alaska Native, Asian American, or Pacific Islander person.
- Having overweight, obesity, high blood pressure, or high cholesterol.

If your child has any two risk factors listed above, talk to your doctor about getting their blood sugar tested. Testing typically begins at 10 years old or when puberty starts, whichever is first, and is repeated every 3 years.

Take action family style

Help your kids take action to prevent type 2 diabetes while they're young. Set a new normal as a family—healthy changes become habits more easily when everyone does them together. Starting early can help kids develop a lifetime of healthy habits. Here are some tips to get started:

Mealtime makeover

- Drink more water and fewer sugary drinks.
- Eat more fruits and vegetables.
- Make favorite foods healthier with swaps like whole grains, lean meats, and more vegetables.
- Get kids involved in making healthier meals.
- Have meals at the dinner table rather than in front of the TV or computer.
- Teach your kids how to read food labels.
- Have meals together as a family as often as you can.
- Avoid insisting kids clean their plates.
- Reward kids with praise instead of food.

Aim for your child to get 60 minutes of physical activity a day.

- Aim for your child to get 60 minutes of physical activity a day (doesn't have to be all at once).
- Make physical activity more fun; try new things.
- Ask kids what activities they like best—everyone is different.
- Limit screen time where possible.
- Plan active outings like walking, hiking, or biking.
- Turn chores into games where you can, with healthy prizes.

Fast facts on diabetes

Total diabetes

40.1 million
Estimated number of people with diagnosed or undiagnosed diabetes in the United States, 2023

12.0%
Estimated percentage of the U.S. population with diabetes

Diagnosed diabetes

29.1 million
Estimated number of people with diagnosed diabetes in the United States, including 28.8 million adults aged ≥18 years

Undiagnosed diabetes

27.6%
Estimated percentage of adults aged ≥18 years with diabetes who are undiagnosed, representing 11.0 million people

Prediabetes

115.2 million
Estimated number of U.S. adults aged ≥18 years with prediabetes

Type 1 diabetes

2.1 million
Estimated number of people with diagnosed type 1 diabetes in the United States, including 1.8 million adults aged ≥20 years and 314,000 children and adolescents younger than age 20 years

Prediabetes: ≥65 years

31.3 million

Estimated number of people aged 65 years or older (52.1%) with prediabetes

Full report

See the full report with the latest data on diabetes incidence, prevalence, complications, cost, and more.